



VIVARIUM

Screen Design Guide

The redesigned, game-grade UI — dock navigation, style guide, labelled wireframes and high-fidelity rendered mockups.

12 screens

Style guide

Wireframes

Rendered mockups

Stage · bubbles · compositing

Screen Design Guide

Every screen, its purpose, a labelled wireframe, and a rendered mockup.

This guide walks the full player-facing surface of Vivarium — from the home dashboard through authoring a cast and a world, to the live Stage and sharing. For each screen you get a short **user story**, what the player **can do**, a numbered **wireframe** mapping the key regions, and a **stylish rendered mockup** of how it could look. It opens with the style guide that ties them all together.

01	World Dashboard	Home	02	Starter Library	Home
03	The Forge — Character Creation	Authoring	04	Character Profile & Patch History	Authoring
05	The Web — Relationship Graph	Authoring	06	The Atlas — World Map	Authoring
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Look & Feel — the Style Guide

A game, not a dashboard. A storybook you can play inside.

The interface behaves like a **high-quality game HUD**, not a web app: there is no admin sidebar. Navigation lives in a **floating dock** at the bottom centre (Home · Cast · Bonds · World · Play · Share) — the active room lifts and glows. World name and credits float as **glass chips** in the top corners. Every editor is a “room” of the same game: content sits on **floating frosted-glass panels** over a soft aurora backdrop of blurred colour blobs. On the Stage, the chrome melts away entirely and the scene takes over. The goal is *processing fluency* — everything reads at a glance, detail is one tap deep.

Palette



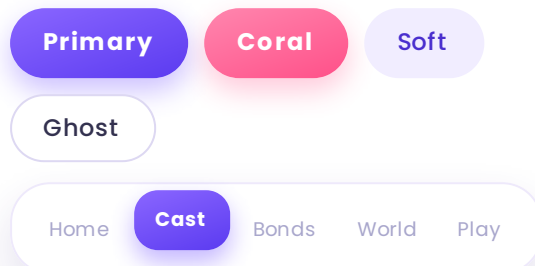
Violet leads; teal supports; coral is the playful highlight (love, interventions); gold marks credits & the active speaker. Buttons are soft gradient pills with an inner top-light, so they feel gently three-dimensional.

Type & components

Poppins — UI & display

Lora — narration, thoughts & dialogue

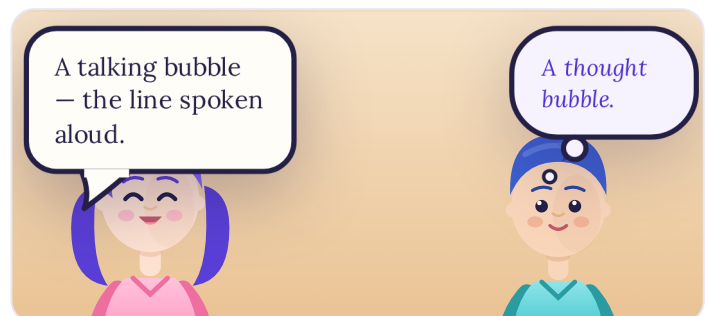
BUTTONS, CHIPS & DOCK



The dock — the active room lifts and glows.

The Stage device

The signature trick: **green-screen cut-outs over a reusable background**, plus tappable comic **bubbles** with an ink outline.



Characters are drawn with soft shading, eye highlights and arms; generated on a flat chroma field, matted to transparent PNGs, and composited side-by-side over a blurred location — so scenes assemble instantly and cheaply.

Motion & feel. The dock icon lifts with a spring; rooms cross-fade; nodes bloom open; bubbles pop in; warm light rests on the scene while the score crossfades between moods. Nothing is abrupt — every transition reinforces the calm, page-turning rhythm of turn-based play.

World Dashboard

“Where am I, and which of my little worlds do I step back into?”

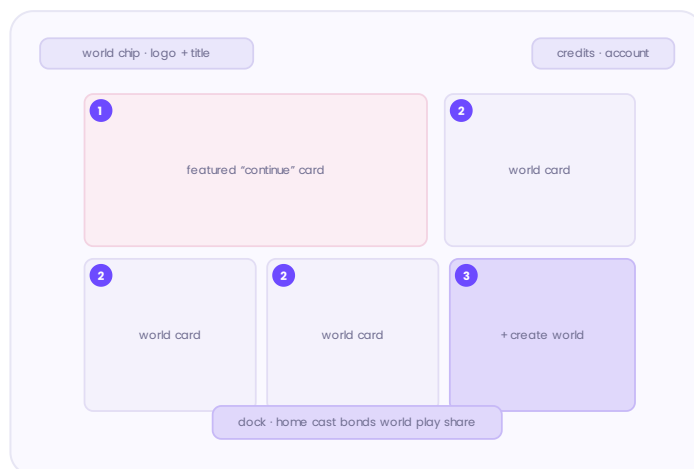
The home base. The player lands here after signing in and sees every world they’ve made as a cover-art card, plus a credit balance and a clear path to start something new or browse the starter library.

THE PLAYER CAN

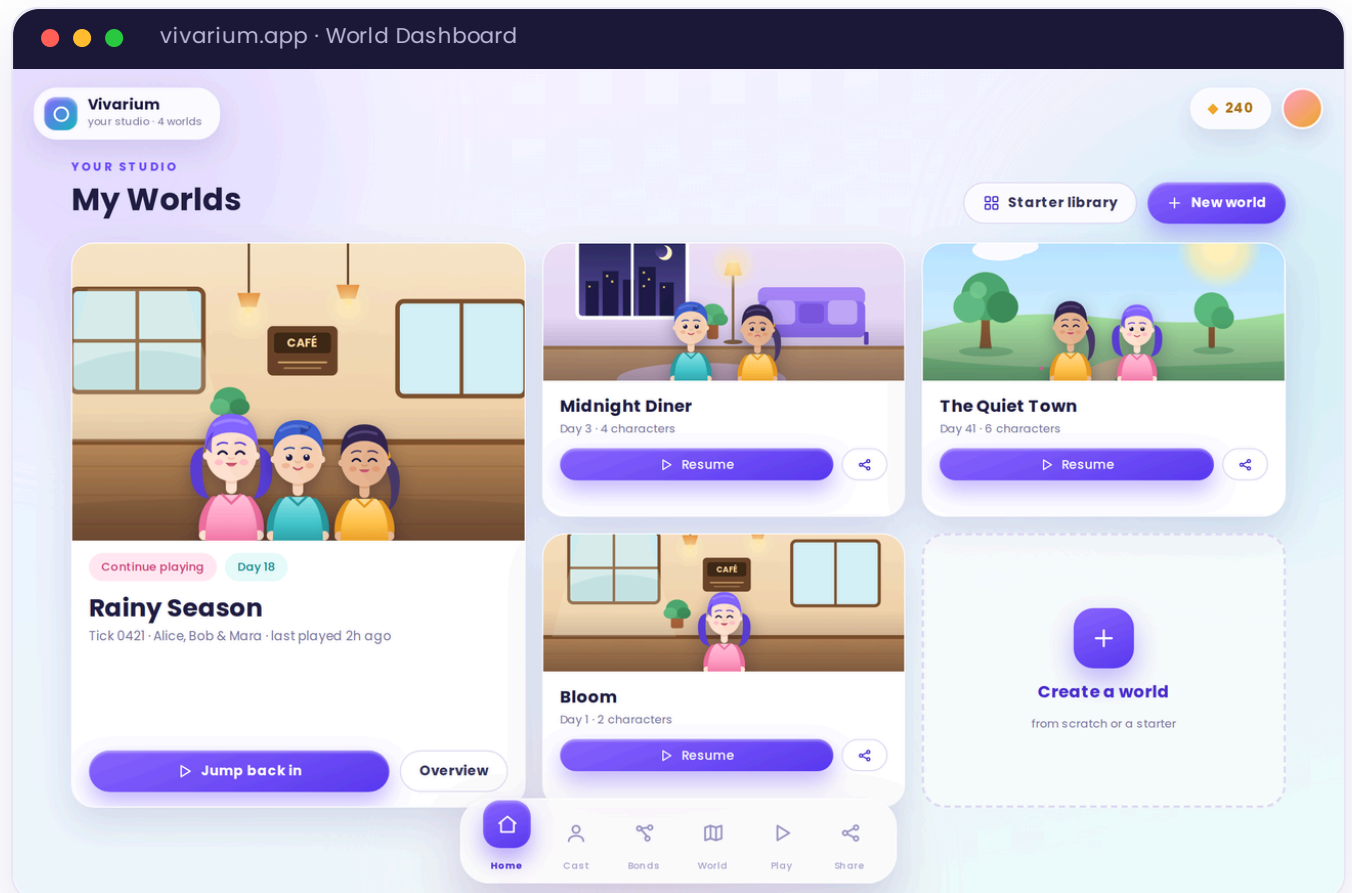
- Resume any saved world (one tap on its card)
- Create a new world from scratch
- Open the Starter Library
- Peek at a world’s overview, or share it
- See credit balance at a glance

KEY ELEMENTS

- 1 Featured / Continue card** — The most-recent world, enlarged, with a “Jump back in”.
- 2 World cards** — Cover scene, title, day/tick, cast avatars, Resume + share.
- 3 Create-a-world tile** — Dashed call-to-action to start fresh or from a starter.
- 4 Top bar** — World count, Populate shortcut, credit balance, account.



World Dashboard



A stylish, lighthearted take on how World Dashboard could look and feel.

- 1 Featured / Continue card** — The most-recent world, enlarged, with a “Jump back in”.
- 2 World cards** — Cover scene, title, day/tick, cast avatars, Resume + share.
- 3 Create-a-world tile** — Dashed call-to-action to start fresh or from a starter.
- 4 Top bar** — World count, Populate shortcut, credit balance, account.

Starter Library

“I don’t know what to make — give me a world I can just start.”

A browsable gallery of pre-built worlds (seeds) with a ready cast and setting. Newcomers pick one, press play, and start writing their own history from a proven starting point; creators publish their own here.

THE PLAYER CAN

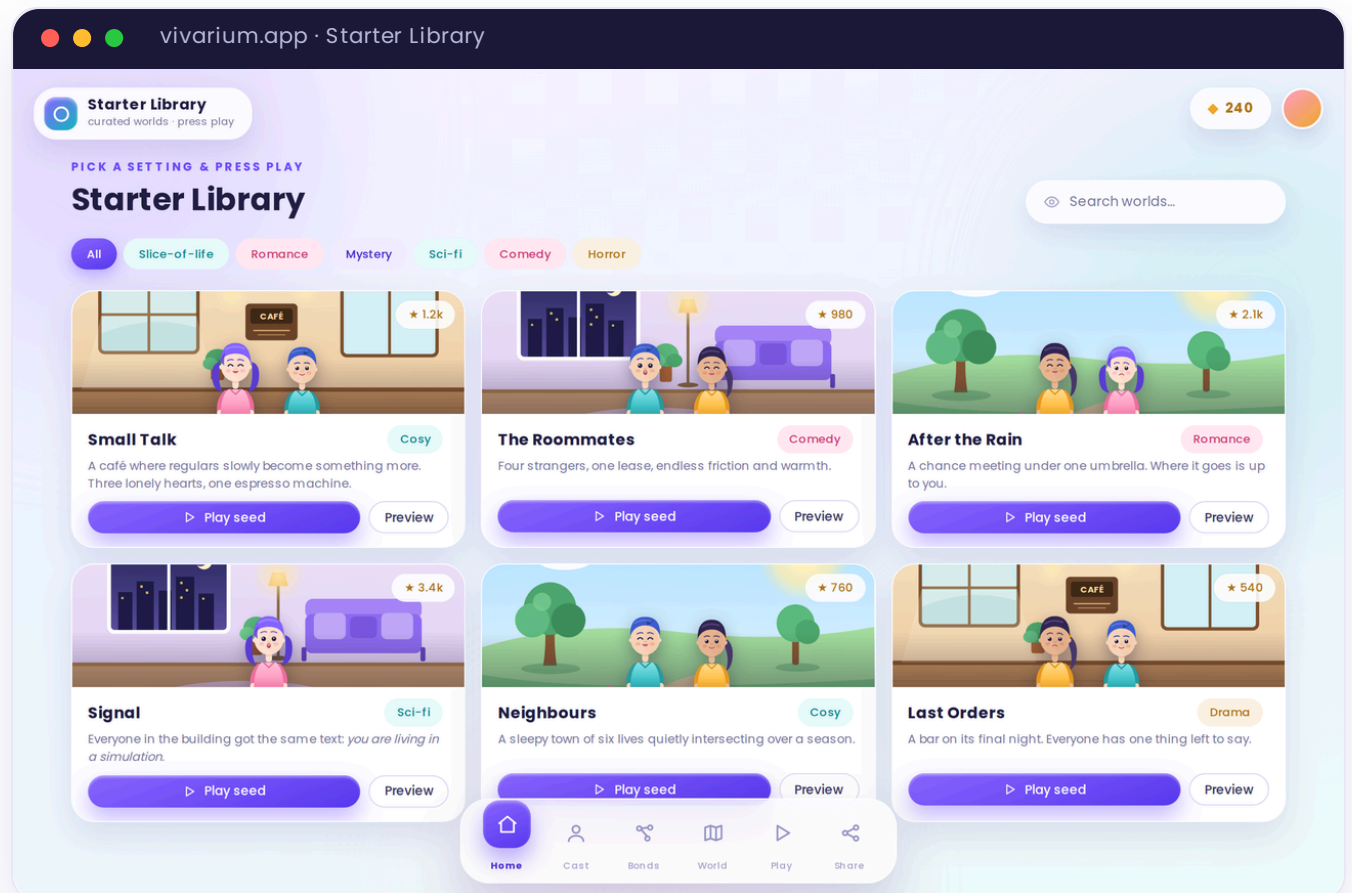
- Filter by genre; search by name
- Preview a world before committing
- Play a seed (starts a fresh copy)
- See popularity (installs) and author

KEY ELEMENTS

- 1 Genre filter row** — All / Slice-of-life / Romance / Mystery / Sci-fi / ...
- 2 Search** — Find a world by name or theme.
- 3 World cards** — Cover, title, genre tags, one-line pitch, ★ installs.
- 4 Card actions** — Play seed (primary) + Preview.



Starter Library



A stylish, lighthearted take on how Starter Library could look and feel.

- 1 Genre filter row** — All / Slice-of-life / Romance / Mystery / Sci-fi / ...
- 2 Search** — Find a world by name or theme.
- 3 World cards** — Cover, title, genre tags, one-line pitch, ★ installs.
- 4 Card actions** — Play seed (primary) + Preview.

The Forge — Character Creation

“Talk a person into existence, and watch them get drawn.”

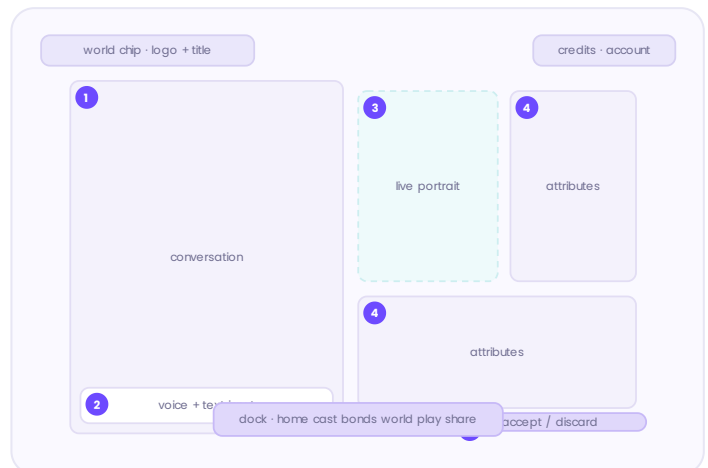
A conversational studio. The player describes a character in natural language (typed or spoken); the assistant interviews them, drafts a full profile, and generates a green-screen portrait in the world's art style. No sliders — just conversation and approval.

THE PLAYER CAN

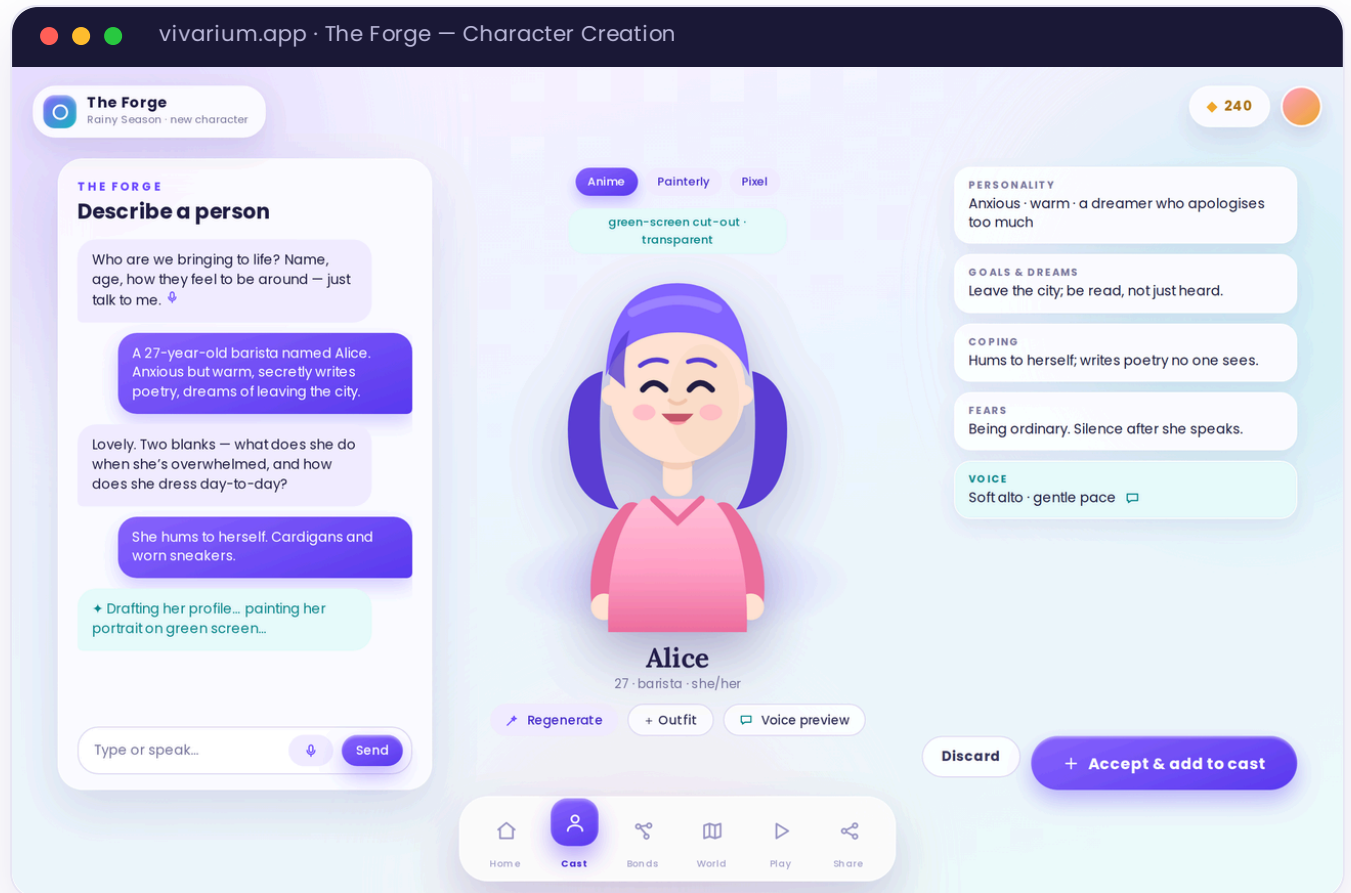
- Describe a character by text or voice (mic)
- Answer the assistant's follow-up questions
- Choose the art style
- Regenerate the portrait / add an outfit
- Preview the voice
- Accept & add to the cast, or discard

KEY ELEMENTS

- 1 Conversation panel** — Assistant ↔ player chat, with drafting status.
- 2 Voice + text input** — Type or hold-to-speak; Send.
- 3 Live portrait** — Green-screen cut-out on a transparency checker; art-style menu.
- 4 Attribute panel** — Age, personality, goals, coping, voice — as they fill in.
- 5 Accept / discard** — Commit the character to the world.



The Forge — Character Creation



A stylish, lighthearted take on how The Forge — Character Creation could look and feel.

- 1 **Conversation panel** — Assistant ↔ player chat, with drafting status.
- 2 **Voice + text input** — Type or hold-to-speak; Send.
- 3 **Live portrait** — Green-screen cut-out on a transparency checker; art-style menu.
- 4 **Attribute panel** — Age, personality, goals, coping, voice — as they fill in.
- 5 **Accept / discard** — Commit the character to the world.

Character Profile & Patch History

“Who did this person start as — and everything they’ve become since.”

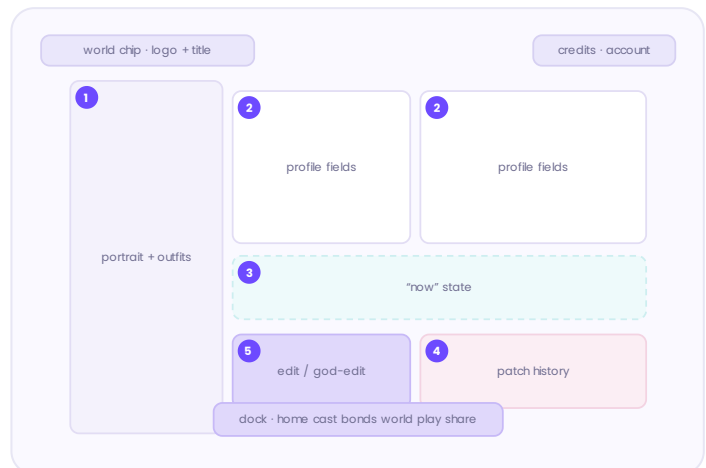
The full dossier for one character: an immutable base profile on the left/centre, and a git-like “Life so far” timeline on the right showing every state change — conditions, moods, beliefs, physical changes — with timestamps. God-editing lets the player intervene directly.

THE PLAYER CAN

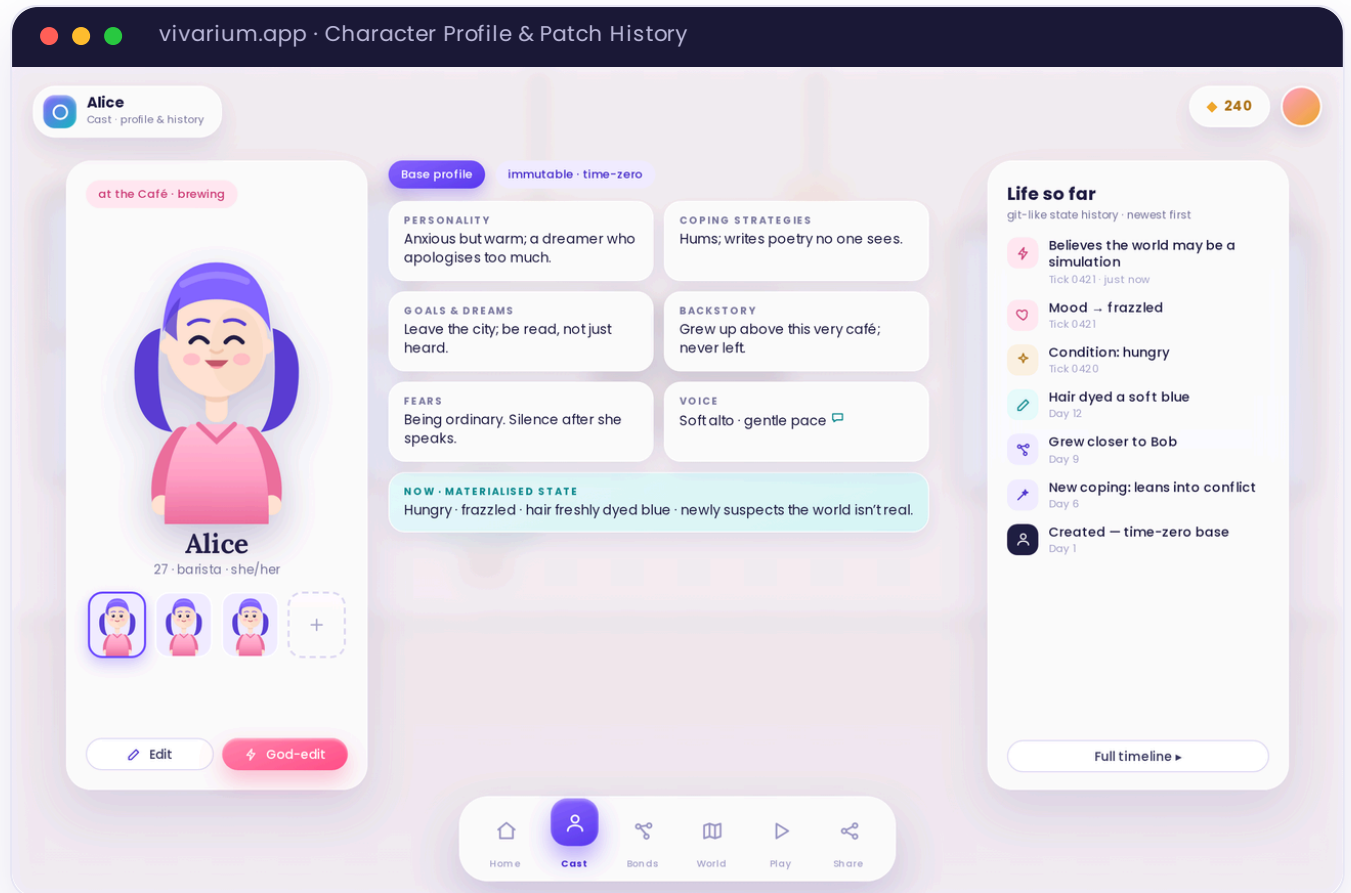
- Read and edit the base profile
- Switch/add outfits; preview the voice
- Scroll the patch history (life so far)
- See the current materialised state
- God-edit to apply a change directly
- Jump back to the cast

KEY ELEMENTS

- 1 **Portrait + outfits** — Current look, outfit variations, voice chip, location.
- 2 **Base profile fields** — Personality, goals, fears, coping, backstory.
- 3 **“Now” panel** — The current materialised state (base ⊕ patches).
- 4 **Patch history** — Git-like log of changes with category icons + dates.
- 5 **Edit / God-edit** — Normal edit vs. a divine intervention.



Character Profile & Patch History



A stylish, lighthearted take on how Character Profile & Patch History could look and feel.

- 1 Portrait + outfits** — Current look, outfit variations, voice chip, location.
- 2 Base profile fields** — Personality, goals, fears, coping, backstory.
- 3 “Now” panel** — The current materialised state (base + patches).
- 4 Patch history** — Git-like log of changes with category icons + dates.
- 5 Edit / God-edit** — Normal edit vs. a divine intervention.

The Web — Relationship Graph

“How does everyone feel about everyone?”

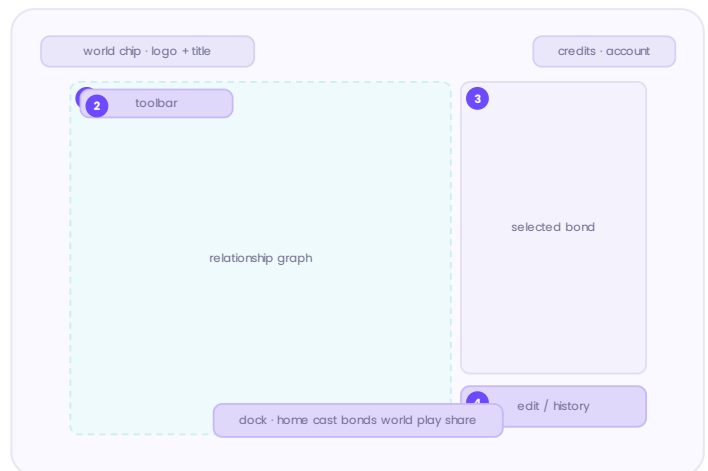
An interactive graph of round portrait nodes joined by directed, labelled arrows. Bonds can be asymmetric (Alice loves Bob; Bob sees a regular). Selecting an edge opens its description, strength, and history; the bonds update themselves as the story runs.

THE PLAYER CAN

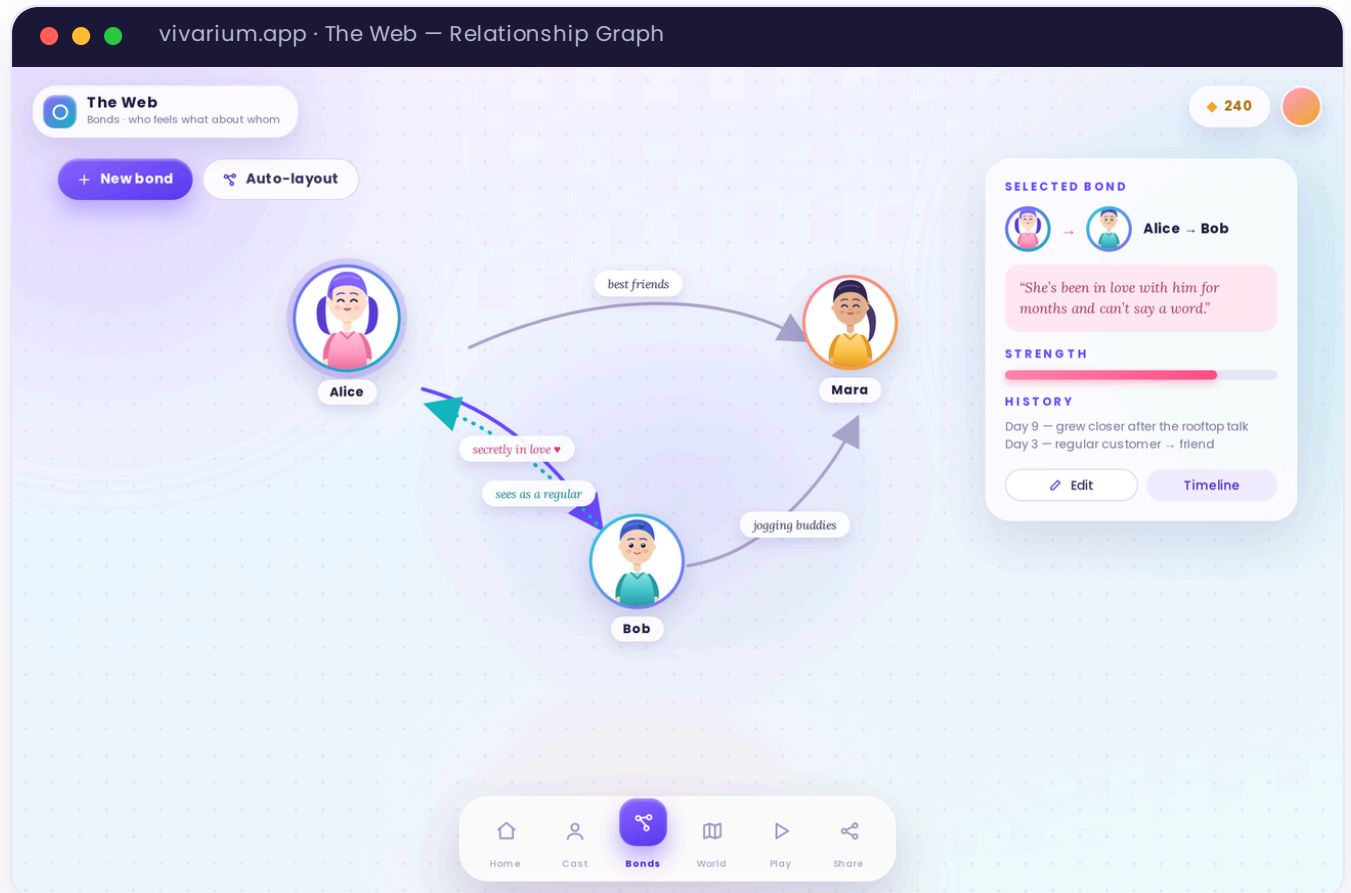
- Pan / zoom the graph; auto-layout
- Add a bond (draw a directed arrow)
- Describe a bond in your own words
- Inspect a bond's strength & history
- Open a character's profile from a node

KEY ELEMENTS

- 1 **Graph canvas** — Portrait nodes + directed, labelled edges.
- 2 **Toolbar** — + Bond, auto-layout, zoom.
- 3 **Selected-bond panel** — Description, strength meter, history.
- 4 **Edit / history** — Edit the bond or view its full timeline.



The Web — Relationship Graph



A stylish, lighthearted take on how The Web — Relationship Graph could look and feel.

- 1 Graph canvas** — Portrait nodes + directed, labelled edges.
- 2 Toolbar** — + Bond, auto-layout, zoom.
- 3 Selected-bond panel** — Description, strength meter, history.
- 4 Edit / history** — Edit the bond or view its full timeline.

The Atlas — World Map

“Where are all the places, and how do you move between them?”

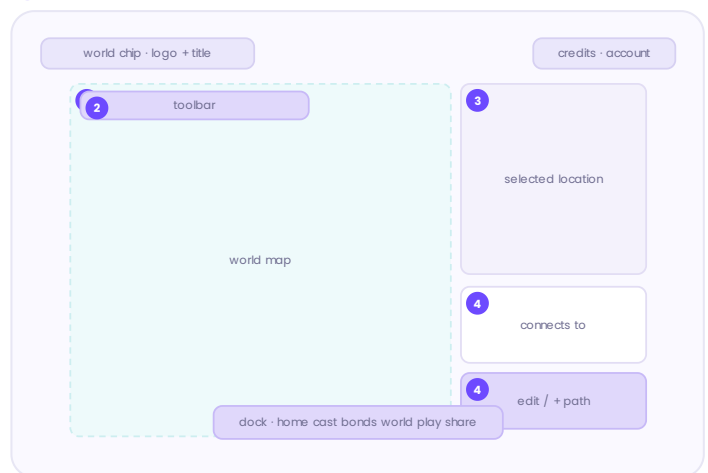
A stylised mind-map of locations grouped into places (Alice’s apartment, Downtown) and joined by paths. Distances are aesthetic, not geographic. Each node shows a generated background thumbnail; selecting one lets you regenerate its art or wire up new paths.

THE PLAYER CAN

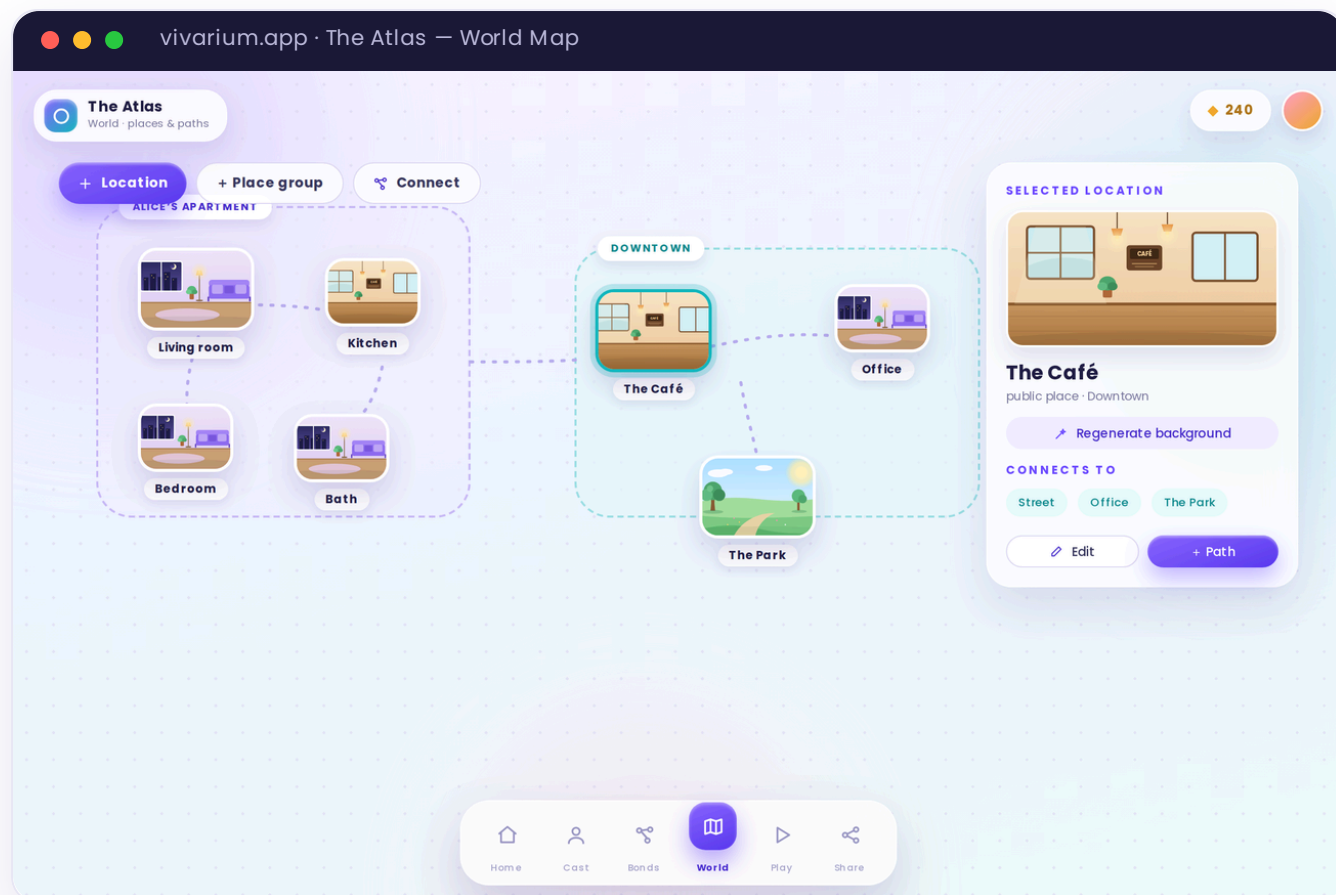
- Add a location, a place-group, or a path
- Pan / zoom the map
- Select a location to edit it
- Regenerate a location’s background
- See what a location connects to

KEY ELEMENTS

- 1 Map canvas** — Location nodes clustered into place-groups, joined by paths.
- 2 Toolbar** — + Location, + Place group, connect.
- 3 Selected-location panel** — Background preview, type, regenerate.
- 4 Connections** — The paths leading out of this place.



The Atlas — World Map



A stylish, lighthearted take on how The Atlas — World Map could look and feel.

- 1 Map canvas** — Location nodes clustered into place-groups, joined by paths.
- 2 Toolbar** — + Location, + Place group, connect.
- 3 Selected-location panel** — Background preview, type, regenerate.
- 4 Connections** — The paths leading out of this place.

Populate — AI Fills the Blanks

“Give Bob three coworkers — one he clashes with.”

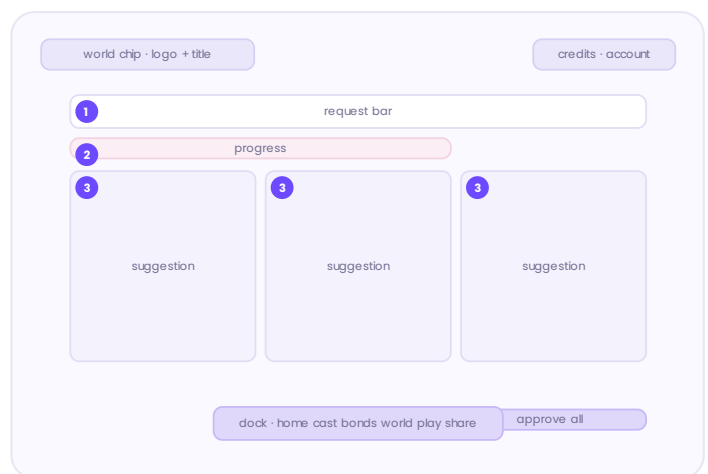
Hand authoring to the agent. The player types or speaks a request; the AI drafts consistent characters (profiles, portraits, plausible relationships and homes) and presents them in a review tray. Nothing joins the world until the player approves it.

THE PLAYER CAN

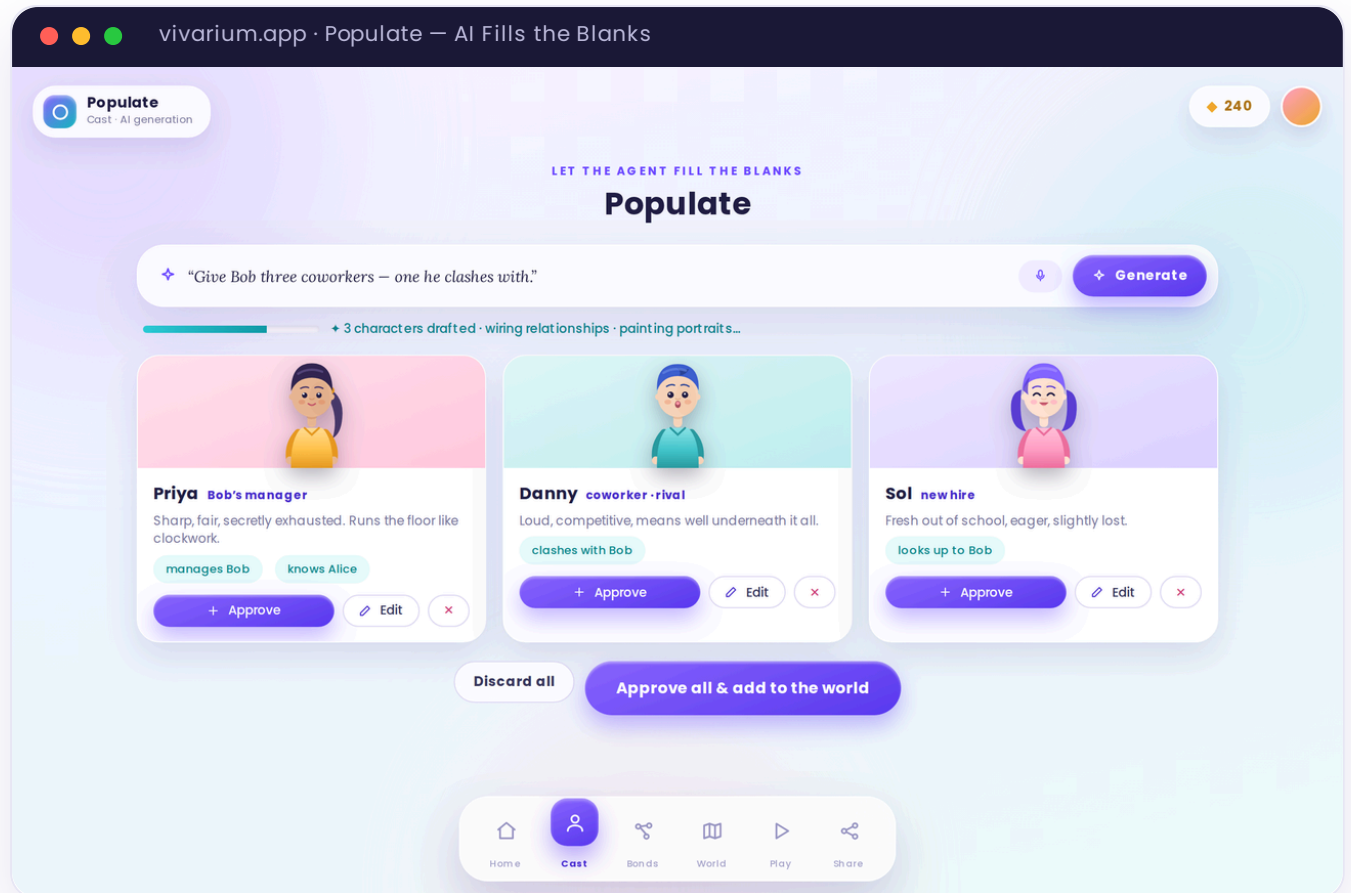
- Ask for new characters in plain language
- Watch generation progress
- Review each suggestion (profile + portrait + bonds)
- Approve, edit, or discard individually
- Approve all at once

KEY ELEMENTS

- 1 Request bar** — Natural-language prompt + voice + Generate.
- 2 Progress** — Live status while the AI drafts and draws.
- 3 Suggestion cards** — Portrait, name, role, bio, proposed bonds.
- 4 Per-card actions** — Approve / Edit / Discard; or approve all.



Populate — AI Fills the Blanks



A stylish, lighthearted take on how Populate — AI Fills the Blanks could look and feel.

- 1 Request bar** — Natural-language prompt + voice + Generate.
- 2 Progress** — Live status while the AI drafts and draws.
- 3 Suggestion cards** — Portrait, name, role, bio, proposed bonds.
- 4 Per-card actions** — Approve / Edit / Discard; or approve all.

Genesis — Story Settings & Start

“Set the tone, decide where everyone begins, and press play.”

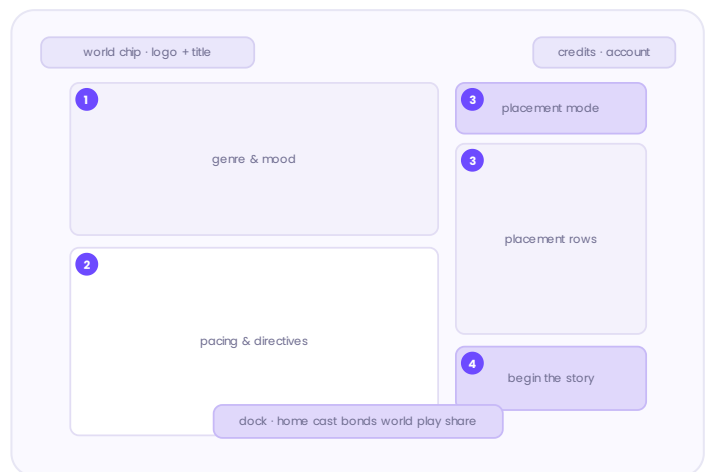
The launch pad. On the left the player dials in the world’s tone — genre, mood, pacing, and free-text directives that ride in the storyteller’s context every tick. On the right they place the cast (or let the AI decide) and then begin.

THE PLAYER CAN

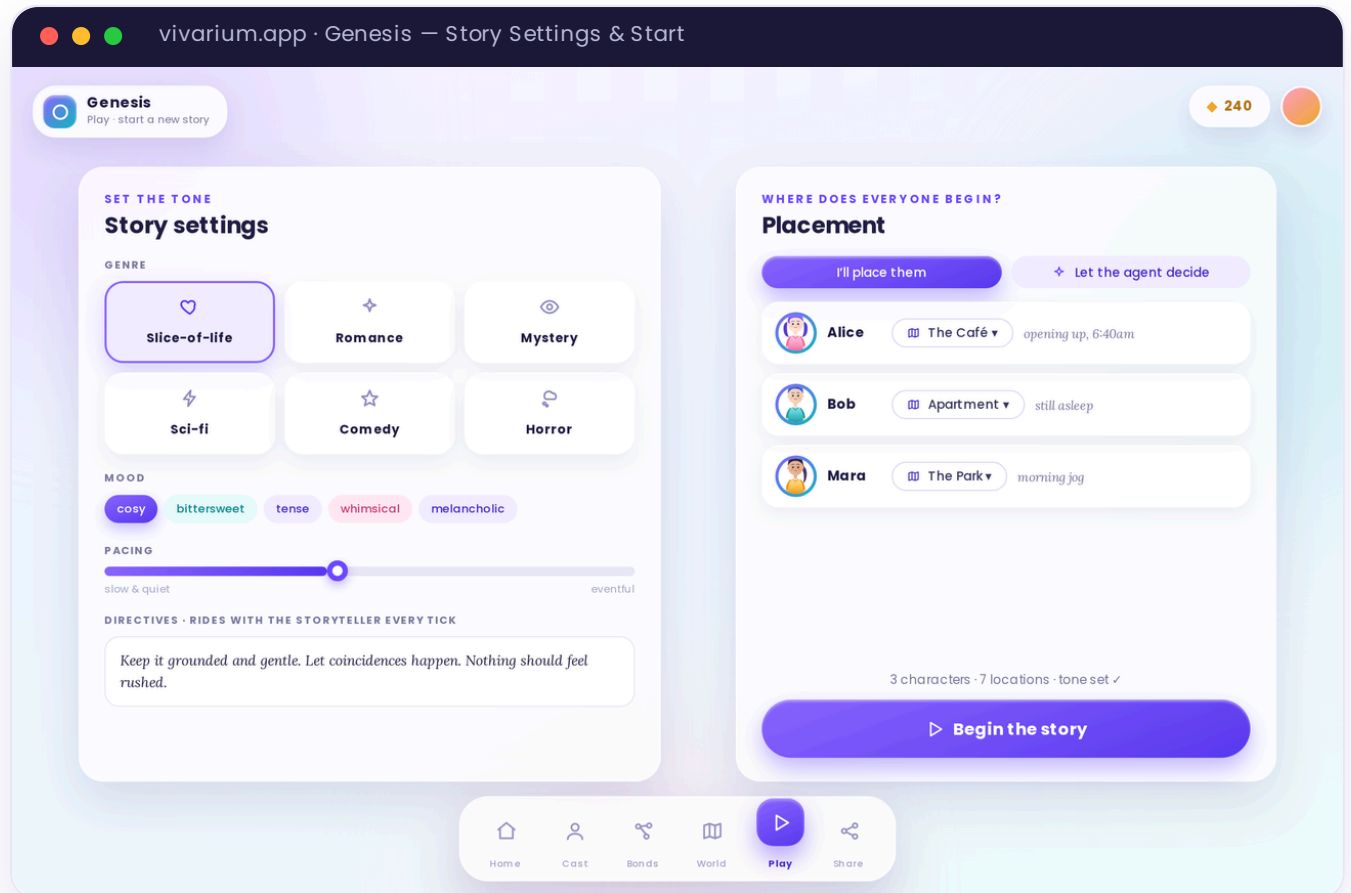
- Pick a genre and mood
- Set pacing (slow ↔ eventful)
- Write directives for how the story should feel
- Place characters manually or let the AI decide
- Begin the story

KEY ELEMENTS

- 1 Genre & mood** — Selectable genre cards + mood chips.
- 2 Pacing & directives** — Slider + free-text tone instructions.
- 3 Placement rows** — Each character → location + starting activity.
- 4 Begin** — The big start-the-clock button.



Genesis — Story Settings & Start



A stylish, lighthearted take on how Genesis — Story Settings & Start could look and feel.

- 1 Genre & mood** — Selectable genre cards + mood chips.
- 2 Pacing & directives** — Slider + free-text tone instructions.
- 3 Placement rows** — Each character → location + starting activity.
- 4 Begin** — The big start-the-clock button.

The Stage — Live Gameplay

“Watch a moment unfold — and turn the page.”

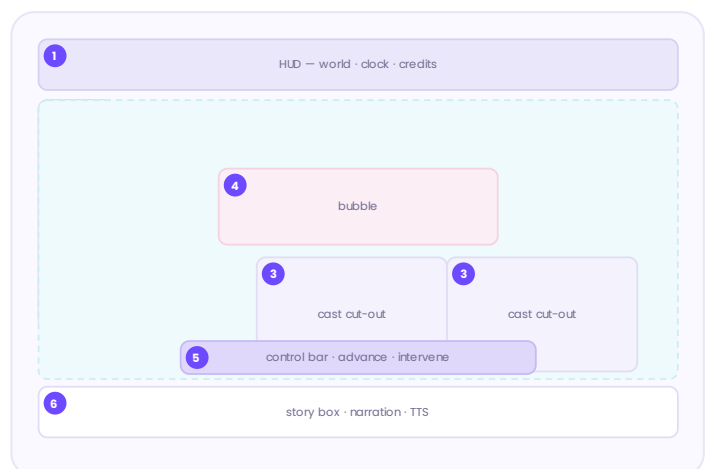
The heart of the game. The chosen location fills the screen (softly blurred); the characters present are composited in front of it as green-screen cut-outs, each with a comic thinking- or talking-bubble. A story box narrates the scene with per-character voices. The player sets how far time jumps, switches perspective, and can intervene like a god.

THE PLAYER CAN

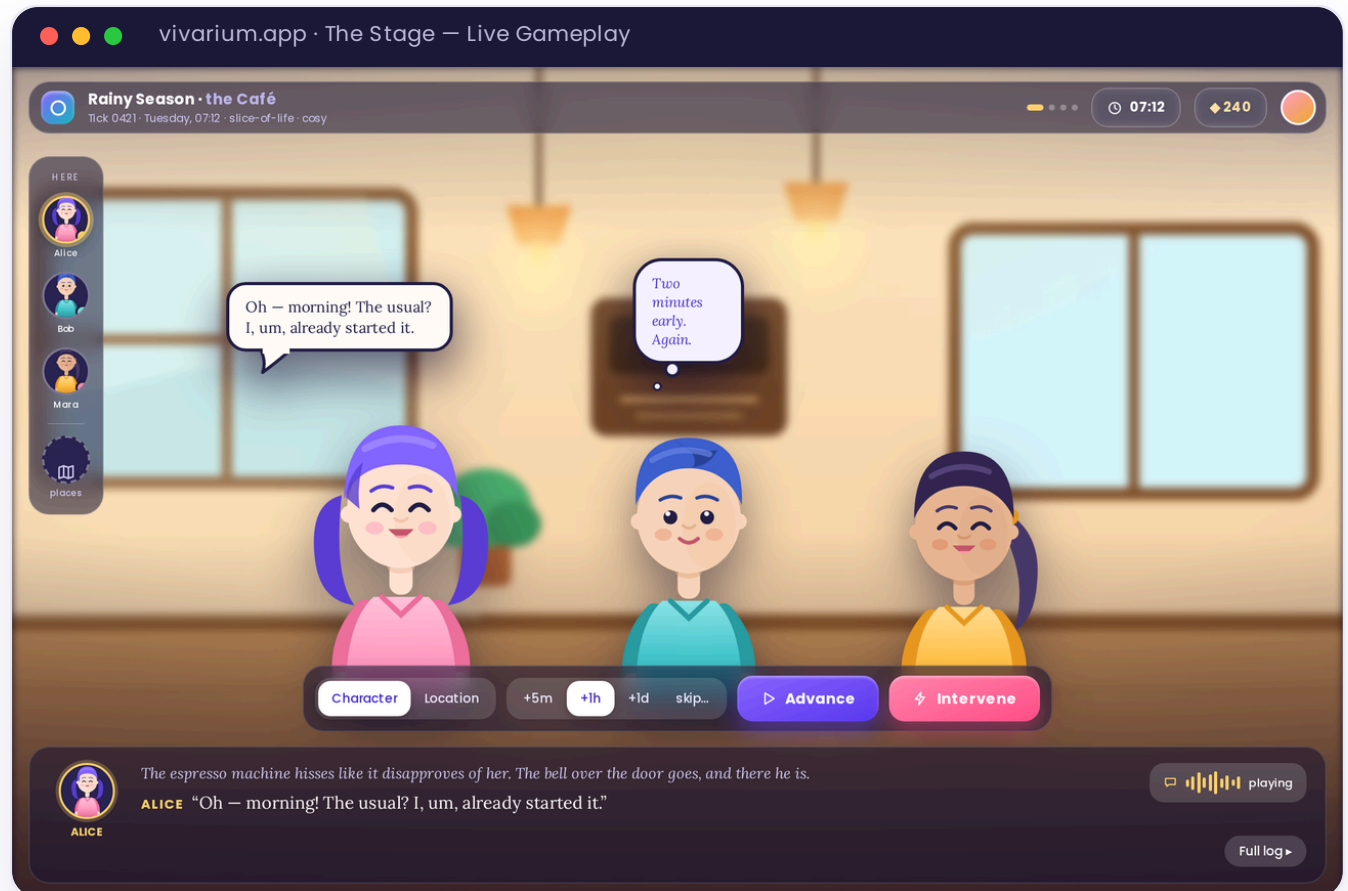
- Advance time (+5m / +1h / +1d / skip)
- Switch perspective — character or location
- Click a bubble to read/hear a character’s thought or line
- Read the narration; hear it via TTS
- Open the full log
- Intervene (god-mode)

KEY ELEMENTS

- 1 **HUD** — World, tick/clock, credits, account.
- 2 **“Here” rail** — Who’s present — tap to switch POV; active is ringed.
- 3 **Composited cast** — Character cut-outs over the blurred background.
- 4 **Bubbles** — Comic thinking (cloud) & talking (speech) bubbles — clickable.
- 5 **Control bar** — Perspective toggle, time-jump, Advance, Intervene.
- 6 **Story box** — Narrator + spoken lines, speaker, TTS “now playing”, full-log.



The Stage — Live Gameplay



A stylish, lighthearted take on how The Stage — Live Gameplay could look and feel.

- 1 HUD** — World, tick/clock, credits, account.
- 2 “Here” rail** — Who’s present — tap to switch POV; active is ringed.
- 3 Compositd cast** — Character cut-outs over the blurred background.
- 4 Bubbles** — Comic thinking (cloud) & talking (speech) bubbles — clickable.
- 5 Control bar** — Perspective toggle, time-jump, Advance, Intervene.
- 6 Story box** — Narrator + spoken lines, speaker, TTS “now playing”, full-log.

Intervention Console

“Reach in like a quiet god and tip the story.”

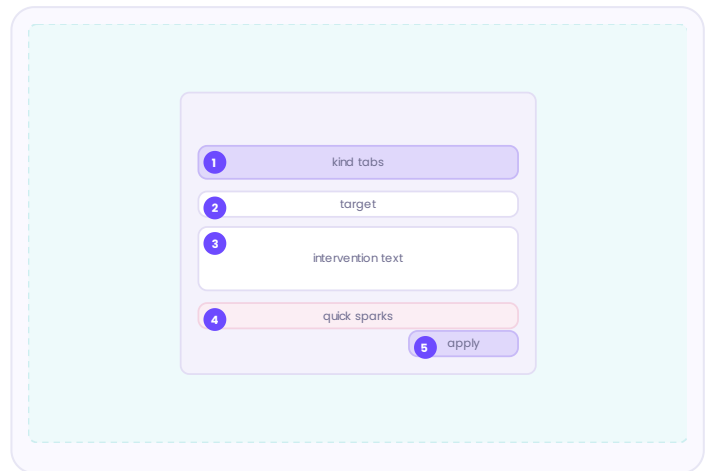
A focused modal over the dimmed stage. The player introduces an event, an idea, a condition, or a piece of directorial steering — targeted at one character or the whole world. They don’t write the characters’ actions; they add a cause, and the cast reacts in character on the next tick.

THE PLAYER CAN

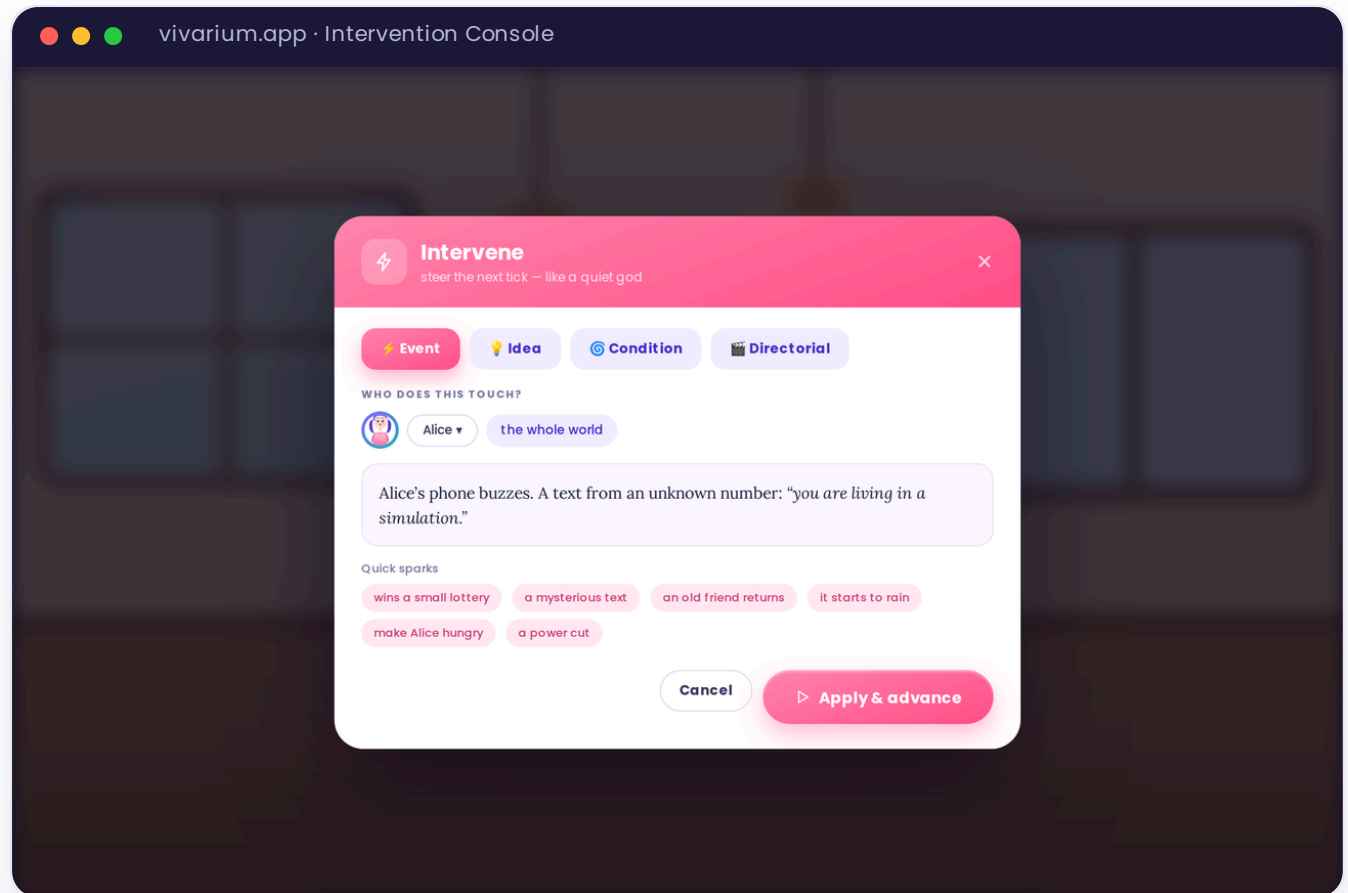
- Choose the kind: Event / Idea / Condition / Directorial
- Target a character or the whole world
- Type the intervention (or tap a quick spark)
- Apply & advance, or cancel

KEY ELEMENTS

- 1 **Kind tabs** — Event · Idea · Condition · Directorial.
- 2 **Target** — Which character or “the whole world”.
- 3 **Intervention text** — What happens / what idea lands / what condition applies.
- 4 **Quick sparks** — One-tap example interventions.
- 5 **Apply & advance** — Commit and run the next tick.



Intervention Console



A stylish, lighthearted take on how Intervention Console could look and feel.

- 1 **Kind tabs** — Event · Idea · Condition · Directorial.
- 2 **Target** — Which character or “the whole world”.
- 3 **Intervention text** — What happens / what idea lands / what condition applies.
- 4 **Quick sparks** — One-tap example interventions.
- 5 **Apply & advance** — Commit and run the next tick.

Character Explorer

“See everyone at a glance, and dive into anyone.”

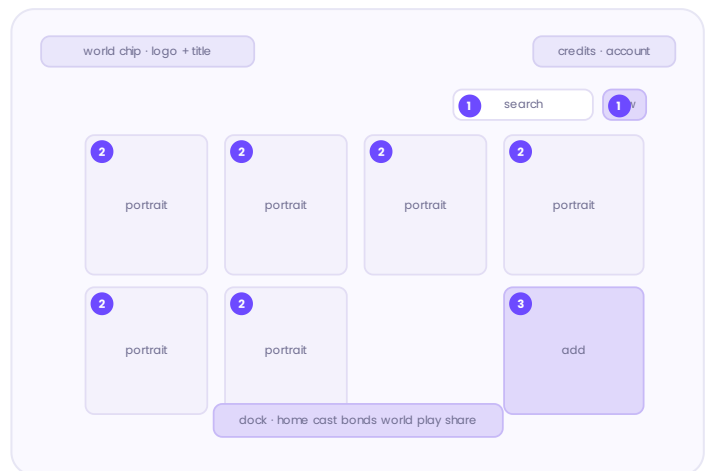
A gallery of the whole cast as round portraits, each showing current mood and location. It doubles as a live dashboard during play and a jumping-off point to any profile. (The Relationship and Location explorers reuse the Web and Atlas, now live.)

THE PLAYER CAN

- Browse / search the cast
- See each character’s current mood & location
- Open a full profile
- Add a new character

KEY ELEMENTS

- 1 Search + New** — Find someone; start a new character.
- 2 Portrait grid** — Round cut-outs with mood + location chip.
- 3 Add tile** — Create another character.



Character Explorer



A stylish, lighthearted take on how Character Explorer could look and feel.

- 1 Search + New** — Find someone; start a new character.
- 2 Portrait grid** — Round cut-outs with mood + location chip.
- 3 Add tile** — Create another character.

Share & Export

“Hand this world to a friend.”

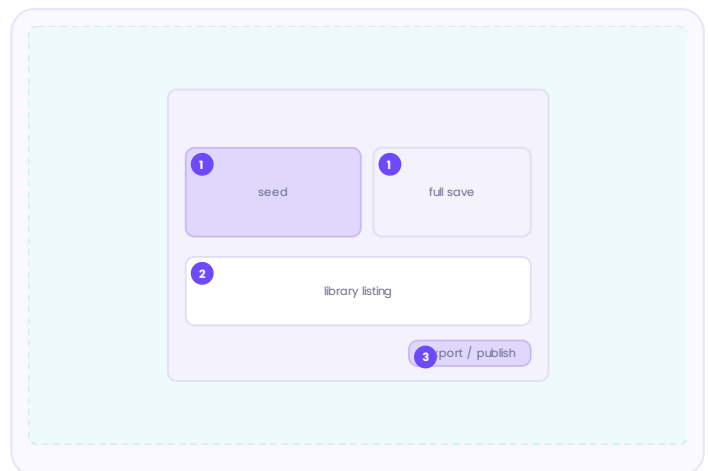
A modal offering the two export formats — a small time-zero seed (setting only) or a full saved game (whole timeline + patches + assets) — plus the option to publish to the Starter Library with a cover, tags and a pitch, or just export a bundle / copy a link.

THE PLAYER CAN

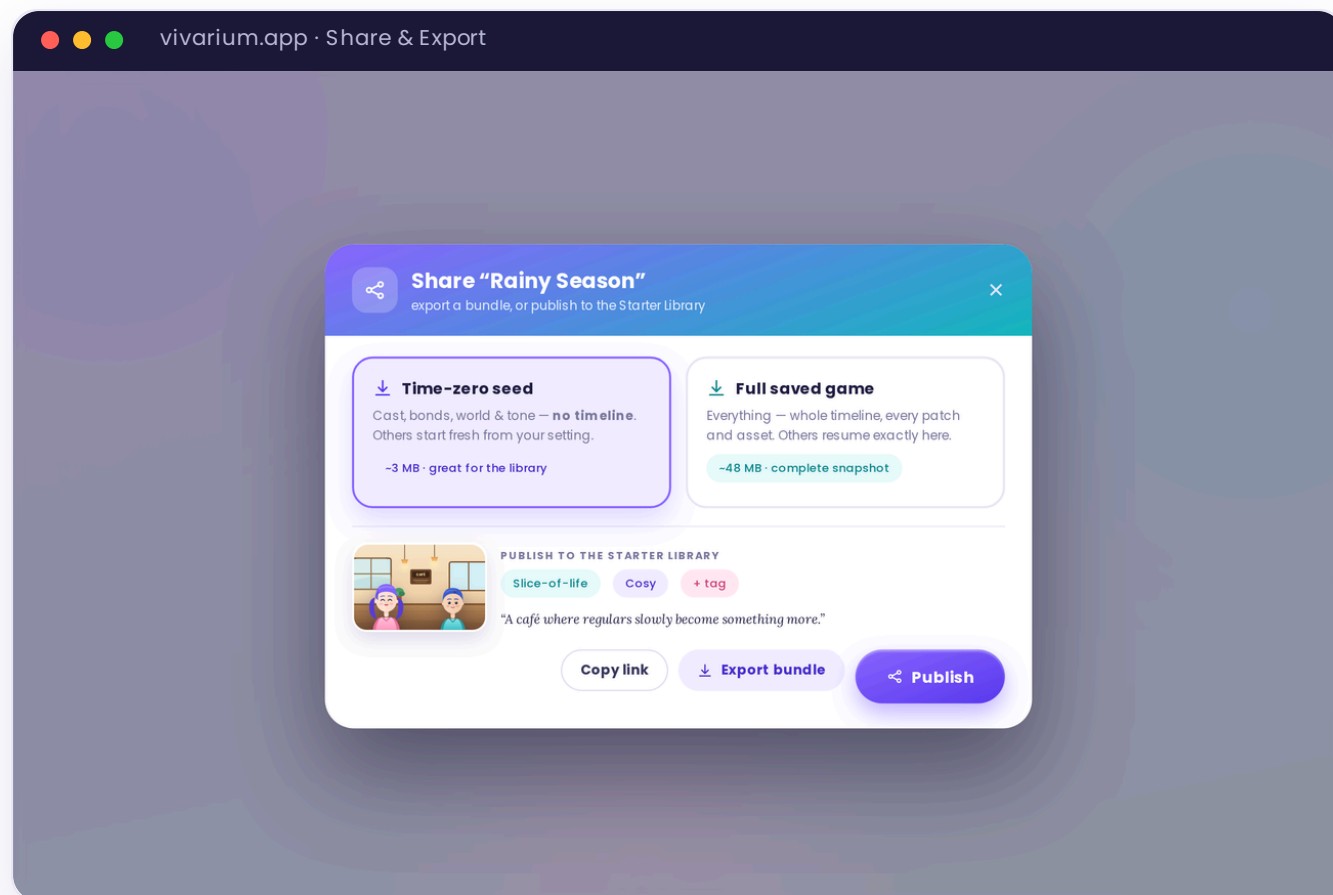
- Choose seed vs. full-save export
- Fill in library listing (cover, tags, pitch)
- Export a bundle to download
- Publish to the library, or copy a link

KEY ELEMENTS

- 1 Export choice** — Time-zero seed vs. full saved game, with sizes.
- 2 Library listing** — Cover, genre tags, one-line pitch.
- 3 Actions** — Copy link · Export bundle · Publish.



Share & Export



A stylish, lighthearted take on how Share & Export could look and feel.

- 1 **Export choice** — Time-zero seed vs. full saved game, with sizes.
- 2 **Library listing** — Cover, genre tags, one-line pitch.
- 3 **Actions** — Copy link · Export bundle · Publish.